

KEY (1942)



Axis countries
Germany, Italy, and Japan formed a group in 1940.



The Allies
Britain, France, Russia, and the United States teamed up.



Neutrals
Some countries didn't fight on either side.



Battle sites
Brave fighting took place on distant battlefields.

German troops surrounded the city of Stalingrad from 1942 to 1943 but were defeated by the Russians.

Stalingrad

SCALE

0 500 miles
0 500 kilometers

SCALE

0 1000 miles
0 1000 kilometers

SOVIET UNION

JAPAN

America dropped the world's first atomic bomb on Hiroshima, Japan, in 1945.

Hiroshima

Okinawa, 1945

Iwo Jima, 1945

The Japanese suffered a major defeat at the hands of the US Navy at Midway in 1942.

Midway

The Japanese attack on Pearl Harbor in December 1941 brought America into the war.

Pearl Harbor

Leyte Gulf, Philippines

America won against Japan in the largest WWII naval battle in 1944.

Guadalcanal 1942-1943

Coral Sea, 1942

PACIFIC OCEAN

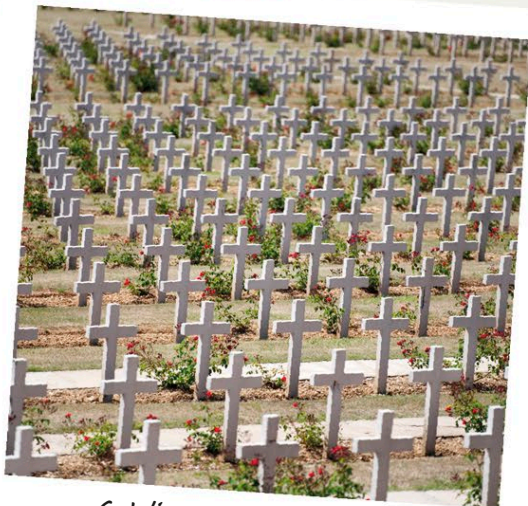


Pearl Harbor

On December 7, 1941, Japanese planes bombed US Navy ships based at Pearl Harbor, Hawaii. The attack took the United States by surprise and led it to join the war on the Allies' side.

The cost of war

World War II was the deadliest war in human history. More than 38 million civilians and 22 million troops lost their lives. Another 25 million people were killed by disease and lack of food.



Soldiers' graves in France

